

Coping Strategies

Introduction

This document summarizes evidence-based coping strategies for stress, anxiety, and low mood based on guidance from WHO, NIMH, MedlinePlus, and the Mental Health Foundation. It is intended for educational use in a RAG system.

Healthy coping strategies

- Maintain regular sleep and physical activity.
- Stay socially connected.
- Practice mindfulness and relaxation.
- Break large problems into smaller steps.
- Limit alcohol and recreational drugs.
- Seek professional support if symptoms persist or interfere with daily life.

When to seek help

If distress is severe, lasts for weeks, or includes thoughts of self-harm, seek immediate professional evaluation or emergency assistance.

Key Takeaways

Healthy coping skills can improve resilience but do not replace professional treatment when needed.

References

World Health Organization – Mental health resources
National Institute of Mental Health – Caring for Your Mental Health
MedlinePlus – Mental Health
Mental Health Foundation (UK) – How to look after your mental health